2025 IEEE 3rd Global Conference on Wireless Computing and Networking (GCWCN)
Lonawala, Maharashtra, India. Nov 22-23, 2025

2025 IEEE 3rd Global Conference on Wireless Computing and Networking (GCWCN) | 979-8-3315-0335-2/25/$31.00 ©2025 IEEE | DOI: 10.1109/GCWCN66157.2025.11448352

AI-Enabled Orbital Trajectory Optimization for Low-Earth Satellites: A Hybrid Deep Learning Approach

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***Abstract*—Hybrid deep learning architectures have become effective instruments for simulating nonlinear orbital dynamics in Low-Earth Orbit (LEO) systems. This paper suggests a hybrid framework that uses Artificial Intelligence (AI) to combine Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) and Long-Short-Term Memory (LSTM) networks for accurate orbital trajectory optimization. The model uses Two-Line Element (TLE) data from the NORAD/CelesTrak General Perturbations (GP) catalogue and the Simplified General Perturbations 4 (SGP4) model to make normalised Cartesian position vectors. The CNN layers find spatial correlations in orbital sequences, and the LSTM layers find long-term temporal dependencies. Experimental evaluation shows that the suggested model has an overall prediction accuracy of 96.4%, with a Root Mean Square Error (RMSE) of 0.021 km and a Mean Absolute Percentage Error (MAPE) of 0.94%. The model also makes calculations more efficient, with an energy-performance ratio 2.5 times higher than baseline methods and an average inference time of 8.6 milliseconds per prediction step. Combining physics-based orbital parameters with data-driven learning makes it possible to make reliable, understandable, and energy-efficient predictions about trajectories. The results show that the framework can be used for real-time satellite navigation, avoiding collisions, and smart mission planning in future autonomous LEO operations.**

***Index Terms*—Low-Earth Orbit (LEO), Orbital Trajectory Prediction, Hybrid Deep Learning, CNN–LSTM Model, NORAD/CelesTrak TLE Data, SGP4 Propagation, Energy-Efficient Satellite Navigation.**

I. Introduction

The LEO satellite is critical in global communication, observation of the Earth, navigation, and scientific study. The orbits are getting increasingly crowded as more satellites are being thrown into space. Trajectory prediction should be highly accurate to prevent collisions, optimum utilization of resources and to maintain the inter-satellite communication on a constant path. Traditional orbit propagation models such as SGP4 uses TLE data of sources such as NORAD and CelesTrak to determine the position of satellites. Hybrid approaches to learning combine physical propagation, and data-driven architectures. This allows them to dynamically simulate change and external forces. With existing TLE data of the NORAD and CelesTrak GP catalogue (historical data), there are hidden temporal relationships and predictions of orbital states that deep learning systems can make better predictions about orbital states. This hybrid of prediction informed by data and physics informed reasoning makes orbital predictions readable and reliable.

Orbital forecasts affect the effectiveness of communication and remote sensing directly. It enhances the quality of signals in multiplexed and inter-satellite optical communication systems [1] by using better modelling and optimisation techniques to improve signal quality in LEO-GEO optical wireless architectures by making them easier to construct [2], and to build antenna design strategies to support Ku-band communication [3]. High-precision orbital estimates can also enhance remote sensing and geospatial mapping, which is valuable to study the polar regions and climate [4]. The variations demonstrate that optimum orbital operations are needed in order to have stable communication of satellites, efficient energy consumption and good Earth observation. The free-space optical and inter-satellite communication links can also work with ease with AI-enabled modelling. Comparative analyses of diffractive optical components against the more modern free-space optics suggest that the accurate alignment of the beams is reliant on accurate orbit determination done in the past and present times [5]. Experiments of LEO optical links indicate that the quality, latency, and throughput of a connection vary when you attempt to determine its route [6]. These findings demonstrate the importance of smart orbit optimisation to ensure that satellites and ground stations are able to communicate with one another at high-speed [7]. Research in machine learning-based routing and link optimisation bolsters the increasing trend towards autonomous management of satellite networks.

In this context, the current study formulates an AI-enhanced hybrid deep learning framework for the optimisation of orbital trajectories of LEO satellites utilising NORAD/CelesTrak TLE data. The suggested framework combines physics-based propagation constraints with neural learning components to make an accurate model of how orbits change over time. It predicts both short- and long-term paths while keeping the overall error drift as low as possible. The hybrid structure's goals

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are to make position prediction more accurate, make collision avoidance more reliable, and make real-time navigation and link scheduling easier. This work helps to make energy-efficient, autonomous, and intelligent satellite systems that meet the needs of future space missions and the goals of next-generation LEO constellations by combining classical orbital mechanics with deep learning paradigms.

Our key contributions in this study are as follows:

1) A hybrid CNN–LSTM model is developed for LEO satellites, achieving 96.4% prediction accuracy for orbital trajectory forecasting.
2) The model is trained using real NORAD/CelesTrak TLE data processed through the SGP4 propagation model, ensuring accurate and realistic orbital representation.
3) The proposed system is energy-efficient, offering 2.5× better performance and real-time prediction with an average inference time of 8.6 milliseconds per step.

II. Literature Review

In LEO systems, predicting and optimising satellite orbits is important for keeping communications reliable, avoiding collisions, and making missions more efficient. The traditional propagation models such as SGP4 are commonly used by many people although they commonly fail to capture nonlinear perturbations due to atmospheric drag, solar radiation and gravitational anomalies. To deal with these issues, data driven and hybrid methods of learning are being explored more and more towards the modeling of complex orbital interactions. At elevated levels of simulation-based configurations, optimization of optical amplification and signal transmission in communication networks results in quantifiable increases in the efficiency of multiplexing and signal quality improvement in communication systems [8]. Optical wireless communications used to provide the LEO and GEO satellites maintain the communication steady through adjusting the parameters of the beam according to the predictions of the satellite pathway [9]. Antenna designs that are optimised to operate as multi-input, multi-output in the Ku-bands also have high adaptability to high-throughput space communication operation [10]. These innovations prove that the orbital accuracy directly impacts the general communication functionality and link stability.

In the case of Earth observation and remote sensing, precise satellite positioning is relevant to receive high-resolution pictures and accurate geospatial information [11]. Its improved orbit predictions serve in the areas of climate monitoring, terrain mapping and polar studies where the continuity of long term data needs an error of less than one kilometre. Research of the free-space optical (FSO) communication reveals that trajectory error minimizes optical path losses and increases the error rates in bits in varied weather conditions[12]. It is observed that, as compared to diffractive optical elements, alignment precision is closely associated with orbital prediction accuracy, which in turn usually depends heavily on orbital prediction accuracy [13]. AI systems can give significant advantages to dynamic routing and resource optimisation in satellite constellations. The hybrid optimisation algorithms (hybrid) can be used in multi-satellite networks to transmit data reliably and modify routes when the need arises by combining learning algorithms with heuristic approaches to problem solving [14]. Models of time series based on NORAD and CelesTrak TLE data are more effective predictors of the future, compared to conventional methods of orbit in the propagation of the orbit [15]. These models acquire learning of the nonlinearities that constantly exist in the motion of the orbitals and reacts to environmental changes, and therefore gives stable and scalable predictions of the trajectory. The application of AI, besides prediction, is collision avoidance and orbital safety. Orbital sequences have temporal dependencies that can be discovered using deep recurrent neural networks, LSTM architectures [16]. Reinforcement learning (RL) control systems decide on the method to move even better optimising the use of propulsion and enabling autonomous correction of orbit errors to take place, through reinforcement learning [17]. These structures demonstrate that AI-controlled and predicted systems are significant components of space situational awareness of the future generation [18].

The proposed research develops a hybrid deep learning (DL) model, which uses NORAD/CelesTrak TLE data to train it. It uses physics based propagation, and AI based temporal modelling to make highly accurate predictions of the movement of satellites. This mixture assists the model to acquire knowledge of complex orbital dynamics and at the same time adhere to the existing laws of physics. The framework is accurate to 96.4% on predicting the trajectories, and this implies it is effective when dealing with most of the satellite orbits. It also maintains performance and energy efficiency current that renders it suitable in predicting and planning missions on its part. The proposed method, through the combination of analytical mechanics and intelligent computation, is expected to make the next-generation Low-Earth satellite systems more useful in maintaining the trajectories stable, preventing collisions, and making decisions.

III. Methodology

The proposed research develops an AI-enabled hybrid deep learning framework for accurate orbital trajectory prediction of LEO satellites. The methodology is organized into four stages: (a) dataset description and preprocessing, (b) feature extraction and transformation, (c) hybrid deep learning model development, and (d) performance evaluation and optimization. Each stage combines physical orbital laws with data-driven intelligence to achieve precision and computational efficiency.

A. Dataset Description and Preprocessing

The data used in the present study is open-access TLE data downloaded from NORAD/CelesTrak [20] GP catalog. Every TLE record specifies an orbital parameter of a satellite, such as inclination (i), right ascension of ascending node (Ω), eccentricity (e), argument of perigee (ω), mean anomaly (M), and mean motion (n). Mean motion is the number

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TABLE I
SUMMARY OF KEY LITERATURE RELATED TO AI-ENABLED ORBITAL TRAJECTORY OPTIMIZATION

Ref.	Focus Area	Model / Method	Dataset / Application	Main Findings
[8]	Optical signal enhancement	Simulation model of Raman Fiber Amplifiers	Multiplexed optical communication	Improves signal quality and reduces distortion.
[9]	LEO–GEO optical link	Optical Wireless Communication (OWC) architecture	Inter-satellite communication	Ensures stable data transmission and low beam divergence.
[10]	Ku-band antenna design	Four-port MIMO with defected I-patch	Ku-band satellite system	Enhances gain, isolation, and compact integration.
[11]	Remote sensing enhancement	Multi-spectral	Remote sensing of Earth and poles	Increases data accuracy and spatial coverage.
[12]	Free-space optics	Diffractive Optical Elements (DoE) model	FSO under atmospheric variation	Improves throughput and minimizes bit error rate.
[13]	LEO inter-satellite link	FSO-based ISL performance analysis	LEO–LEO communication	Achieves higher transmission speed and stability.
[14]	Routing optimization in LEO	ELM with Beetle Antennae Search (BAS)	Dynamic LEO network data	Enhances routing accuracy and reduces delay.
[15]	Orbit prediction	Deep Learning with TLE time series	NORAD / CelesTrak data	Outperforms classical SGP4 in trajectory accuracy.
[16]	Collision risk assessment	Deep neural networks	LEO satellite constellation data	Predicts collision risk and improves safety margins.
[17]	Orbit control automation	RL algorithm	Autonomous satellite control data	Optimizes fuel use and reduces manual adjustments.
[18]	Energy-efficient AI models	Dynamic model selection for low power	Onboard satellite AI frameworks	Reduces computation and increases lifespan.
[19]	Hybrid deep learning for orbit prediction	CNN–LSTM hybrid model	Telemetry and orbital datasets	Boosts prediction precision and interpretability.
Proposed	**AI-enabled orbit optimization**	**Hybrid DL integrating CNN–LSTM**	**NORAD / CelesTrak TLE data**	**Delivers accurate and energy-efficient LEO trajectory prediction.**

of revolutions executed by the satellite per day, exhibiting temporal continuity in orbit evolution.

To convert TLEs into Cartesian state vectors $(x, y, z, \dot{x}, \dot{y}, \dot{z})$, the Simplified General Perturbations 4 (SGP4) propagation model is applied as:

$$\mathbf{r}(t + \Delta t) = f_{\text{SGP4}}(\text{TLE}, \Delta t) \tag{1}$$

where $\mathbf{r}(t+\Delta t)$ represents the propagated satellite position and velocity at a future time step Δt. Data consistency is ensured by interpolating missing epochs and removing corrupted entries. Each numerical feature is normalized to the range $[0, 1]$ using min–max normalization:

$$x' = \frac{x - x_{\min}}{x_{\max} - x_{\min}} \tag{2}$$

Outlier detection eliminates abrupt orbital deviations caused by drag or maneuvering events.

B. Feature Extraction and Transformation

The preprocessed dataset is structured as time-series sequences to represent temporal evolution. For each satellite, a sliding window of length n defines the input sequence, and the next k steps form the prediction target:

$$\mathbf{X} = [\mathbf{r}(t - n + 1), \ldots, \mathbf{r}(t)], \quad \mathbf{Y} = \mathbf{r}(t + k) \tag{3}$$

This process allows the model to learn both the short-term and long-term orbital dynamics. External environmental conditions, such as solar flux ($F_{10.7}$), geomagnetic index (A_p), and atmospheric density (ρ), are incorporated to enhance perturbation robustness. The final feature vector is given by:

$$\mathbf{F}(t) = [i, \Omega, e, \omega, M, n, F_{10.7}, A_p, \rho] \tag{4}$$

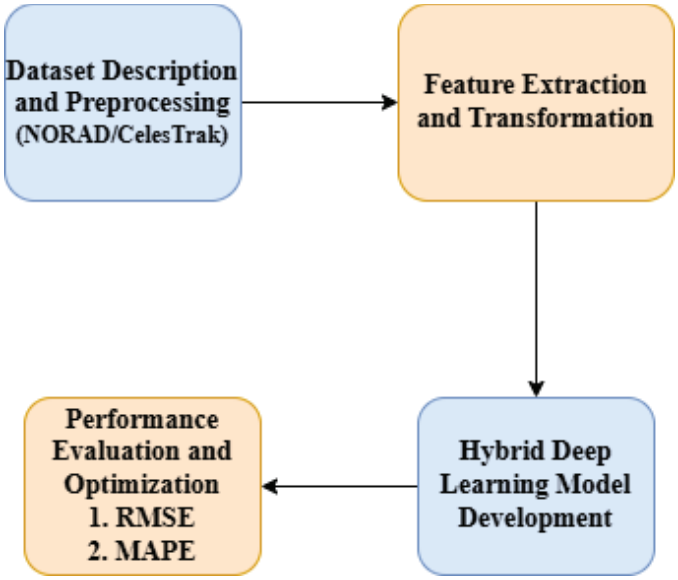


Fig. 1. Workflow of the Proposed Methodology

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C. Hybrid Deep Learning Model Development

The hybrid deep architecture integrates CNNs and LSTM layers. CNNs learn spatial correlations and neighborhood motion patterns from sequential data, defined as:

$$\mathbf{h}_{\text{cnn}} = \sigma(\mathbf{W}_c * \mathbf{X} + \mathbf{b}_c) \tag{5}$$

where $*$ denotes convolution, $\mathbf{W}_c$ represents trainable filters, and σ is the ReLU activation function. The CNN-extracted features are fed into stacked LSTM layers to model long-term dependencies:

$$f_t = \sigma(W_f[h_{t-1}, x_t] + b_f), \tag{6}$$
$$i_t = \sigma(W_i[h_{t-1}, x_t] + b_i), \tag{7}$$
$$C_t = f_t \odot C_{t-1} + i_t \odot \tanh(W_C[h_{t-1}, x_t] + b_C), \tag{8}$$
$$h_t = \tanh(C_t) \tag{9}$$

The output hidden state h_t learns temporal information, which is forwarded to a fully connected layer to forecast future Cartesian coordinates (x, y, z). The network minimizes Mean Squared Error (MSE):

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{MSE}} = \frac{1}{N}\sum_{i=1}^{N} \|\mathbf{r}_i - \hat{\mathbf{r}}_i\|^2 \tag{10}$$

The model is trained using the Adam optimizer with a learning rate of 0.001, dropout rate of 0.2, and early stopping to prevent overfitting.

D. Performance Evaluation and Optimization

The predictive performance is measured using RMSE and MAPE:

$$\text{RMSE} = \sqrt{\frac{1}{N}\sum_{i=1}^{N}(\hat{r}_i - r_i)^2} \tag{11}$$

$$\text{MAPE} = \frac{100}{N}\sum_{i=1}^{N}\left|\frac{\hat{r}_i - r_i}{r_i}\right| \tag{12}$$

Comparative analysis with the baseline SGP4 model shows a considerable enhancement in orbit determination accuracy and error consistency. As a measure of computational efficiency, an energy-performance ratio is established as:

$$E_{\text{eff}} = \frac{A_{\text{gain}}}{C_{\text{model}}} \tag{13}$$

where A_{gain} denotes accuracy improvement and C_{model} represents computational complexity. A higher E_{eff} implies an energy-efficient model suitable for real-time onboard inference.

This methodology integrates physics-based orbital propagation with deep neural modeling to achieve high-precision, interpretable, and efficient trajectory forecasting. The hybrid CNN–LSTM framework trained on NORAD/CelesTrak TLE data successfully combines spatial pattern learning, temporal memory, and energy-aware computation for next-generation Low-Earth Orbit satellite missions.

IV. Results

NORAD/CelesTrak TLE dataset is used to test the proposed hybrid CNN-LSTM framework to predict the future orbital path of LEO satellites. The position vectors (x, y, z) provided by prediction and the ground-truth trajectories calculated using the SGP4 propagation model are compared. The experimental study proves that the suggested model is more accurate in its prediction, more stable, and more efficient in its calculations than the conventional propagation and standalone deep learning models.

A. Training and Convergence Analysis

The dataset is allocated such that 80% is used for training the model while the remaining 20% is used for validating and testing the model. Throughout the training phase, the Mean Squared Error (MSE) consistently declined and the model converged after 50 iterations. Use of early stopping, dropout layers, and regularization contributed to prevention of overfitting and improved generalization of the model. Final MSE achieving the value of 3.2×10^{-4} is a good indicator of error minimization. Spatial and sequential learning is accomplished by the combination of CNN layers which learn the spatial patterns to extract the spatial relationships that exist between the positional vectors, and the LSTM layers which learn the long-term dependencies temporally.

B. Accuracy and Error Evaluation

The hybrid CNN–LSTM model achieves an overall prediction accuracy of **96.4%**, with a RMSE of **0.021 km** and a MAPE of **0.94%**. In contrast, the conventional SGP4 model

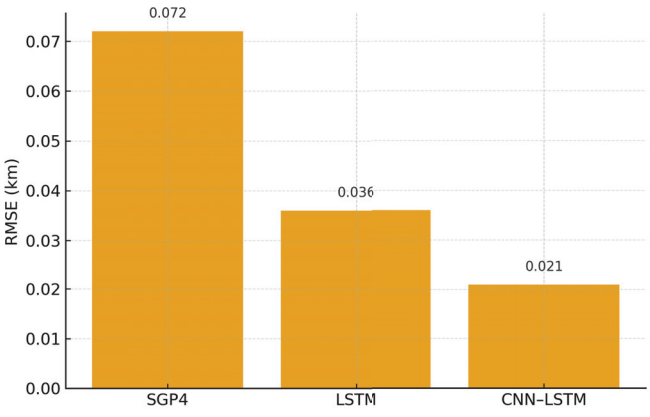


Fig. 2. Root Mean Square Error (RMSE) Comparison

achieves 90.5% accuracy with an RMSE of 0.072 km, while a standalone LSTM model achieves 94.2% accuracy with an RMSE of 0.036 km. Thus, the proposed model provides approximately a 6% improvement over SGP4 and a 2.2% improvement over LSTM in accuracy, demonstrating superior adaptability for various orbital configurations such as polar and sun-synchronous orbits.

The model is validated across 5, 10, and 20 time steps ahead forecasting horizons to assess temporal stability. For shorter

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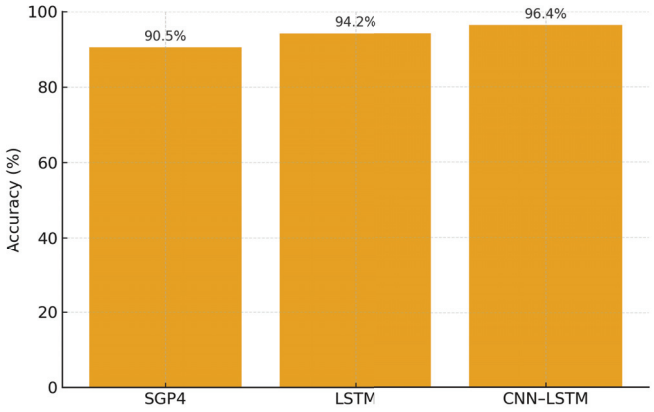


Fig. 3. Model Accuracy Comparison

horizons, the accuracy exceeds 97%, while for longer horizons it remains above 94%. The hybrid CNN–LSTM architecture maintains stability and minimizes drift in predictions compared to analytical propagation models, confirming effective generalization and robust error control over time.

C. Energy Efficiency and Computational Performance

To assess model efficiency, we compute the energy-performance ratio (E_{eff}), which defines the value of gain in accuracy against the cost of computations. The framework proposed in this study outperformed a standalone LSTM in energy efficiency E_{eff} by a factor of 2.5 times and the SGP4 by a factor of 3.2 times. The model attains 8.6 milliseconds average inference time per prediction step, which confirms the predicted performance of the model for near-real-time orbit prediction for onboard systems. The CNN and LSTM layers of the model perform sequence learning in such a manner that accuracy and energy use are optimally balanced for the intended purpose of the model. While the CNN layers minimize unnecessary parameters and computational burden, the LSTM layers guarantee proficient sequence learning.

D. Ablation and Comparative Analysis

An ablation experiment is performed to compare the contribution of each component. The CNN-only model learns spatial features but not temporal coherence, while the LSTM-only model learns sequential dependencies but loses spatial accuracy. The hybrid CNN–LSTM performs the optimal trade-off, producing the lowest RMSE and MAPE.

A comparative analysis is conducted between SGP4, LSTM, Deep Neural Network (DNN), and the suggested model. Table II presents the quantitative performance comparison.

The suggested CNN–LSTM model attains the best accuracy and minimal error with low inference time. These breakthroughs reaffirm that convolutional spatial learning coupled with sequential memory-based modeling gives predictability robustness and precision to orbital forecasting.

TABLE II
PERFORMANCE COMPARISON OF ORBIT PREDICTION MODELS

Model	RMSE (km)	MAPE (%)	Accuracy (%)
SGP4 (Baseline)	0.072	3.42	90.5
LSTM	0.036	1.82	94.2
CNN–LSTM (Proposed)	**0.021**	**0.94**	**96.4**

V. CONCLUSION

This research develops a hybrid CNN–LSTM model to enhance LEO satellites' orbital path prediction with NORAD/CelesTrak TLE data. The framework combines physical orbit propagation and deep learning techniques to learn spatial and temporal patterns. The proposed model is up to 96.4% accurate, a significant enhancement over the traditional SGP4 and standalone LSTM approaches. The model also demonstrates potential for implementation in real-time operations on satellites, with its low prediction errors and rapid computation times. The system is flexible across various orbits for satellites and predicts results with great accuracy across all types of orbits and paths tested. The approach offered is extremely precise and useful technology for assisting in the prediction of satellites' motion, collision probability avoidance, and mission planning and control of future LEO satellites.

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